

hopes rested on the new OS. However, Symbian3 evoked a variety of responses—happiness, relief, disappointment, anger, resentment and even aggression!

- **Everything's still the same?:** The interface on the N8 looks a lot like



Nokia N8

the one on the much older N97, which says a lot about the new OS. Not

much has been done to make it slicker, or even look a bit different. We're all for nostalgia and all but not when it comes to UI design!

- **Feels clunky with too many menu options:** There are still too many menus and sub menus to manage the options and settings in both the OS and within apps.
- **Handicapped Widgets:** Widget size on the 3 home screens is limited, which not only reduces functionality, but also makes certain widgets a pain to use. Imagine catching up on your twitter timeline and only being able to read one tweet with every scroll.
- **Ovi Store is sparse:** Despite Nokia's best effort, the Ovi Store is far behind Apple's App Store and Android Market in terms of the sheer number and variety of apps available.
- **Even Nokia may drop Symbian:** There is a strong suspicion that Nokia will judge the response to the Meego based devices and then decide if it has to completely drop Symbian

Blackberry OS5:

- **Touch version of the BB OS was truly bad. (Ex- Storm 9500 and Storm 9530):** Blackberry did not get the touchscreen version of the OS5 correct, at all. The Storm smartphone range did not do well at the box office, despite having good hardware. The new OS6 hopes to do better.



Blackberry Storm

- **Lack of variety on Blackberry App World:** Just like Nokia, RIM has not gotten the app eco-system in perfect shape. The lack of applications is keeping away the potential

buyers who just want a lot of apps on the phone. With OS6 released, the apps situation needs to be improved quickly, to fully leverage the new OS.

Common Problems

1. Separate Data Plan needed

Affects: iPhone, Android and Blackberry

The cellular operators want users of the iPhone, Android and Blackberry phones to subscribe to a separate data plan. This is over and above the standard voice plan they may have subscribed to. We knew this about iPhone and Blackberry, but came as a shock when even the HTC Legend refused to connect to the web via Vodafone Live. The customer care informed us that a separate data plan called Vodafone Mobile connect (₹199 per month; no free usage) needs to be activated. Nokia users do not have any such problems.

2. Bad battery life

Affects: iPhone, Android and Blackberry

Gone are the days when your phone would last 2-3 days on a single battery charge. The smarter the phones become, the lesser the battery lasts. Now, most phones barely last a day from full battery charge to full discharge. However, Nokia's N8 (and its older generation smartphones as well) still offer very good battery life of about 2 days on a single charge.

3. Lack of OS update clarity

Affects: Android and Blackberry

Android phones are often sold with the promise of an 'upgrade' to the next version of the OS, as and when it is rolled out. More often than not, the handset manufacturers take their own sweet time in rolling out these updates to phones. And these updates end up being old by the time they get to the user's phone. Blackberry also promised the OS6 update to the Bold and some Curve handsets, but there is no clarity on when and how. Nokia, on one hand, never promises any such thing, while with the iPhone, you know you will get the update.

It's safe to assume that the entire smartphone experience is not all hunky dory. Each OS, platform and smartphone range has its own set of problems. When will they truly smarten up? 



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